5. Family Values

Can you tell?

(1) In your family, how do you make the decision to go on a trip?

(2) Do you offer suggestions about the places to visit during the trip?

(3) Do you get to suggest which guests should be invited over during a holiday?

(4) How do you help during preparations for festivals or functions at home?

Role in decision-making

We live together in a family. Every person's likes and dislikes are different. Thoughts and opinions can also differ. We ourselves are different from others. Even so, our thoughts and opinions can match those of others on various topics. We have love and affection for each other. We take care of each other and are concerned about other people's well-being. We talk to each other before making decisions about anything in the house. We consult each other and make decisions that everyone agrees with. In this way, we are part of the decision-making in the family.

What happens when everyone has a role in decision-making?

- Each person gets the opportunity to say what they think.
- By asking everyone's opinions, the subject is thoroughly discussed from every aspect.
- We feel like a more important part of the family when we see that our opinion is valued.

Just as we have a role in making decisions in our family, we also have a role in public decision-making. In newspapers, we read about matters requiring public participation. A few examples of such news have been summarized below.

Read and discuss :

Citizens participate in municipal budget planning. Citizens to decide the matters on which to spend money.

Citizens crowd to suggest improvements to city development plan.

Inauguration of road joining six villages : Joint effort by six villages bears fruit.

We feel the need for minor changes in our environment. It is to our advantage that everyone has a role in making decisions about changes in our surroundings. The government we elect makes decisions regarding public matters. If we feel that a decision made by the government is wrong, we can register our opinion. In this way, we can be a part of the decision-making process.

Think!

Be a part of the decision-making process in your home. Do not form your opinions merely on the basis of what others say. Share your thoughts with others.

Can you tell ?

Note the following situations carefully. State which of the children show honest behaviour.

(1) Afreen borrowed a pencil from Meenu. After she finished using it, she returned it.

(2) Shama fell from her bicycle. However, she told her mother, "Neha pushed me off the bicycle".

(3) Mary took the bag she found in a rickshaw to a police station.

Effects of honest and dishonest behaviour

We do many different things every day. Sometimes we make mistakes. When we realise that we have made a mistake, we should talk about it openly with our friends and family. By doing this, we learn to be honest and find a way to correct our mistakes.

It is also necessary to be honest and sincere in our work. We must try hard to keep the trust in any relationship and never cheat. If we are honest, we do not have to be afraid. But if we are dishonest, we lose our self-confidence. We must be honest at home as well as in public. Everyone respects an honest person. Honesty is our strength.

Do you know ?

In 2011, during a cricket match between India and the West Indies, a bowler caught Sachin Tendulkar right at the beginning of the match. The bowler appealed to the umpire. Thinking that the ball had not touched the bat, the umpire declared Tendulkar not out. However, knowing that the ball had touched his bat, Tendulkar returned to the pavilion though he was declared not out.

Honesty in public life

If we are honest in our public life, we will get better public services and facilities. What happens if we travel on a train or bus without a ticket? Our public transport system will run at a loss and would soon have to shut down. If each person buys a ticket honestly, this problem will not arise.

Honesty can increase efficiency in public life. Honesty is the best way to increase discipline and efficiency in public life.

Advantages of co-operation

In a family, we co-operate with each other. Similarly, in team sports, the more the players co-operate with one another, the better is their game. Instead of keeping the feeling of co-operation restricted to sports, we should bring it into public life as well. Everyone needs co-operation in public life. We, too, need the help of others. Fairs, rallies and other such gatherings can only be arranged successfully if we co-operate with one another.

What's the solution ?

(1) We meet a boy who has lost his way.

(2) While on a trip, we realise that our friend has forgotten her tiffin at home.

(3) Some people are stuck in the lift of a building.

Read and discuss :

Read the dialogue given below. Discuss the problem stated and its solution.

Tolerance

We all have some faults. We can improve on these faults with the help of our family and friends. We may not agree with each other every time. Sometimes, there are disagreements even between friends. At such times, we must try to understand the point of view of others instead of insisting that only our point of view is correct. On such occasions, we must listen to the other person. In this way, we learn to be tolerant. Respecting opinions which are different from our own is called tolerance or broadmindedness.

Tolerance has a special significance in our country. People from various religions, creeds, cultures and following different customs live here. That is why, it is necessary for everyone to be tolerant or broadminded. Diversity can be preserved through tolerance. Diversity enriches our social life. It encourages us to think about others with concern. We can solve problems in our environment by being broadminded.

Gender equality

Boys and girls or men and women are equal as human beings. Considering boys and girls to be equal without discrimination is called gender equality. Boys and girls must respect one another. In the company of our friends, we consider all of them to be our equals. We must maintain this sense of equality as citizens when we grow up.

By developing this sense of equality, everyone gets to learn and make progress. Food, clothing, shelter, health and education are the common needs of men and women. For the purpose of equality, each of these needs must be fulfilled properly. Men and women have equal rights to facilities such as these. Similarly, men and women must get equal opportunities of progress.

- **Prepare slogans on gender equality.**

What's the solution ?

The following things are observed in some families.

(1) In some homes, boys' uniforms, textbooks and bags are bought first. Purchases for girls are put off.

(2) When his team lost a kabaddi match, Raju began to cry. Dinesh said, "Why are you crying like a girl ?"

(3) Vandana likes the bat and ball a lot; however, she is given dolls and toy stoves and utensils to play 'house'.

(4) Sarika helps her mother with the cooking and household chores. Her brother is never asked to do the same.

Always remember –

Honesty increases efficiency in public life and makes it possible to avoid wastage of time, money and labour.

What we have learnt –

- Everyone in the family must have a say in decision-making.
- We must be honest in our private and public life.
- Tolerance and co-operation make our community life harmonious and peaceful.
- A tolerant attitude makes it easy to preserve diversity.
- Men and women are equal. It is not right to discriminate between them.

Exercises

1. Fill in the blanks.

(a) Honesty is our ..... .

(b) Everyone needs ..... in public life.

(c) ..... has a special significance in our country.

(d) By developing a sense of equality, everyone gets to ..... .

2. Answer in one line.

(a) Who should make decisions regarding changes in our environment ?

(b) What is tolerance ?

(c) What is gender equality ?

(d) What are the common needs of men and women ?

3. Answer in short.

(a) How do you take part in the decision-making process in the family ?

(b) How do we develop a sense of tolerance ?

Activities

1. Collect stories of social reformers which highlight the values of tolerance and gender equality. Narrate the stories in the class.
2. Can you narrate a few incidents of your honesty ? Do so.

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